MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS 3

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the paragraph. The main idea is what the whole paragraph is about, in one sentence. The details are the facts that support it. Write the main idea in the top box and three supporting details below.

Every Bee Has a Job

grades 4 to 5 · 111 words

A beehive works because every bee in it has a job. The queen is the only bee that lays eggs, up to two thousand a day in summer. Young worker bees stay inside as nurses, feeding the larvae and keeping the nursery warm. Older workers guard the entrance, fan their wings to cool the hive, and build new wax cells. The oldest workers fly out to gather nectar and pollen, sometimes traveling several miles a day. Male bees, called drones, have one job: to mate with a queen from another hive. No single bee could survive alone, but together tens of thousands of bees keep the colony fed, safe and growing.

Main idea one sentence

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

Detail 2

Detail 3

Test your main idea: does every detail in the paragraph tell you more about it? If one does not fit, your main idea may be too narrow.

MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS 3 ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

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Every Bee Has a Job

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Main idea one sentence

A beehive survives because each kind of bee does a specific job for the colony.

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

The queen lays all the eggs, up to two thousand a day.

Detail 2

Worker bees nurse the young, guard, cool and build, then gather nectar and pollen.

Detail 3

Drones mate with queens from other hives.